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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA.
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT.

SECRET—E.

Proceedings, March 1905, Nos. 857—859.

Notes compiled by General Houtum Schindler, C.I.E., on "The History of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf from the fall of the Yarrabi dynasty to the accession of Sultan Sayyid Turki in 1871."

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FOREIGN DEPARTMENT NOTES.

SECRET—E., MARCH 1905.

Nos. 857—859.

NOTES COMPILED BY GENERAL HOUTUM SCHINDLER, C.I.E., ON "THE HISTORY OF OMAN AND EVENTS IN THE PERSIAN GULF FROM THE FALL OF THE YARRABI DYNASTY TO THE ACCESSION OF SULTAN SAYYID TURKI IN 1871."

FROM THE MILITARY ATTACHÉ, BRITISH LEGATION, TEHRAN, No. 1, DATED THE 3RD JANUARY Pro. No. 857.
(RECEIVED 14TH FEBRUARY) 1905.

Forwards some notes on "The history of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf from the fall of the Yarrabi dynasty to the accession of Sultan Sayyid Turki in 1871," compiled by General Houtum Schindler, C.I.E., as he says they may possibly be of use in connection with the compilation of the Persian Gulf Gazetteer. And adds that should they prove of any value, an acknowledgment be made to General Schindler.

Submitted for information. Copy may be sent to Mr. Lorimer, and the notes acknowledged?

G. A. H.,—22-2-1905.

H. P. C.,—22-2-1905.

Please put up drafts.

C. SOMERS COOKS,—23-2-1905.

Drafts submitted for approval. His Excellency may like to see the notes.

G. A. H.,—24-2-1905.

H. P. C.,—24-2-1905.

I doubt if His Excellency need be troubled.

C. SOMERS COCKS,—25-2-1905.

The drafts are for approval.

L. RUSSELL,—27-2-1905.

S. M. FRASER,—1-3-1905.

Of course I ought to see.

C[URZON],—5-3-1905.

TO THE MILITARY ATTACHÉ, BRITISH LEGATION, TEHRAN, No. 1021-E.B., DATED THE 10TH Pro. No. 858.
MARCH 1905.

Requests him to thank General Schindler for his interesting notes, and informs him that a copy was sent to Mr. Lorimer, for information. Adds that the Government of India desire to avoid giving undue publicity to the fact that they are preparing this manual, which is only intended for the confidential use of Government officials.

ENDORSEMENT TO MR. J. G. LORIMER, OFFICER ON SPECIAL DUTY, PERSIAN GULF, Pro. No. 859.
No. 1022-E.B., DATED THE 10TH MARCH 1905.

Forwards a copy of the foregoing letter with enclosures for information.

6102 F. D.

Exd.—W. G. B.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT, MARCH 1905.

History of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf.

Pro. No. 857

NOTES COMPILED BY GENERAL HOUTUM SCHINDLER, C.I.E., ON "THE
HISTORY OF OMAN AND EVENTS IN THE PERSIAN GULF FROM THE
FALL OF THE YARRABI DYNASTY TO THE ACCESSION OF SULTAN
SAYYID TURKI IN 1871."

No. 1, dated Teheran, the 3rd January (Received 14th February) 1905.
From—Lieutenant-Colonel I. A. DOUGLAS, Military Attaché, British Legation,
To—To the Secretary to the Government of India in the Foreign Department.

Promo. 859

I have the honour to forward herewith some notes on "The history of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf from the fall of the Yarrabi dynasty to the accession of Sultan Sayyid Turki in 1871." These notes have been compiled and given to me by General Houtum Schindler, C.I.E., and may possibly be of use to your department in connection with the Gazetteer of the Persian Gulf, which, I understand, is now in course of preparation.

I would ask that, should these notes prove of value, some acknowledgment may be made to General Schindler.

Demi-official, dated the 3rd January 1905.

From—General HOUTUM SCHINDLER, C.I.E.,
To—Lieutenant-Colonel I. A. DOUGLAS, Military Attaché, British Legation, Teheran.

*Encl.
Promo. 859*

I have omitted to give a list of the authorities consulted by me for the compilation of the Notes on Oman. The list ought to appear on the "title page." I have told you that I made the Notes some years ago when the French were trying to settle themselves at Maskat, also that I did not make them with the intention of publishing them. They, therefore, are very fragmentary and must not be considered as specially written for being communicated to the Government. Kindly, when forwarding them, point this out.

I enclose a list of the authorities, which I consulted below, to be pinned on to the title-page of the notes.

For the compilation of these notes the works of the following were consulted:—

Karsten Niebuhr, Danish Savant.
Sestini, Missionary.
Major Taylor, British Army.
General Sir John Malcolm.
Sir John Macdonald Kinneir.
J. Morier, Diplomatic service.
Lieutenant-Colonel Johnson, British Army.
J. H. Stocqueler, Indian Civil Service.
R. B. M. Binning, Indian Civil Service.
Lieutenant C. R. Low, Indian Navy.
E. Stack, Indian Civil Service.
Percy Badger; Translation of the Arabic history of the Imams of Oman.
Mirza Mehdi Khan, Tarikh-i-Nadir Shah and Durrat al Nadiri, Persian.
Sir Lewis Pelly, Persian Gulf Reports.

Notes on the history of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf from the fall of the Yarrabi dynasty to the accession of Sultan Sayyid Turki 1871.

*Sub-enclo.
Encl.
Promo. 859*

Saif bin Sultan (bin Saif bin Sultan bin Malik) *al Y'arrabi* (al Azdi) succeeded to the Imamate of Oman in 1728. It is said of him that he was the first ruler of Oman who engaged Baluchi mercenaries from Makran, and since then the Sultans, or Imams, of Oman have always kept a number of Baluchis in their service and found them their most trustworthy dependants. When Saif had reigned peacefully for about eight years Bal 'Arrab bin Himyar, a cousin of his, claimed the Imamate and raised the standard of revolt. Saif was without any forces sufficient to quell the revolt and appealed for aid to Nadir Shah of Persia. Until a few years before Oman had been tributary to Persia,* and Nadir Shah, considering this appeal a good opportunity for re-establishing his supremacy over Oman, at once acceded to Saif's request and sent a consider-

* NOTE.—The people of Oman throw off their allegiance to Persia at the end of the year 1733, probably, as contemporary writers surmised, in consequence of Nadir Shah's wholesale massacre of Arabs after the battle of Kerkuk in September of that year.

able force from Shiraz under the command of Mirza Muhammad Taki Khan,* the Governor of Fars. The Persian troops landed at Khor Fakkan, March 10th, 1737, and were joined there by Saif. The allied forces encountered Bal 'Arrab in May and completely routed him. Order was now restored, Saif's rule was recognized and the presence of the Persian troops was really no longer necessary, but Mirza Taki Khan, no doubt acting in accordance with Nadir's instructions as to the reconquest of the country, advanced to Baraimi, which he captured, and then to 'Obra where he slaughtered most of the inhabitants only sparing some women whom he sent as slaves to Shiraz.

Saif having become aware of the real intentions of the Persians and much regretting having appealed to them for help against his cousin Bal 'Arrab, now opened negotiations with the latter in view of obtaining his help to expel them. The Persians meanwhile continued to raid the interior with some reinforcements which had come from Shiraz and destroyed villages and massacred their inhabitants. After sacking the two important places, Bahla and Nazva, they returned to the coast, took Azka and then occupied the town of Maskat. The two forts of that place held out and the Persian Commander, bent upon easier conquests, left a part of his forces to besiege them and proceeded to Barka with the remainder. There he was met by a strong detachment under Saif and Bal 'Arrab, who in the meantime had settled their differences, and suffered so severe a reverse that he considered it advisable to quit Oman and return to Persia with all his forces.

Bal 'Arrab had altogether relinquished his claims and become a partisan of Saif, but quite a new pretender now appeared in the person of Sultan bin Murshid who succeeded in gaining the support of the principal Omani chiefs, deposing Saif and being proclaimed Imam. This happened in the month of May 1738.

Saif now again had recourse to the Persians and promised them the important port Sohar on condition of their assisting him in regaining his supremacy by ousting Sultan bin Murshid. The Persians, as they had done in the previous year, at once sent help and even displayed considerable activity, took the two forts of Maskat and the fort of Mattrah, four miles away, by assault and then laid siege to Sohar, where Sultan bin Murshid had taken up a position. A Persian garrison was left in the forts of Maskat. Sohar was valiantly defended by its Governor Ahmad bin S'aid (bin Ahmad bin Muhammad as—S'aidi), a staunch partisan of Sultan bin Murshid, and the Persian forces, after nine months' fruitless efforts and considerable losses, raised the siege and taking sail to Bandar Abbassi returned to Persia. Sultan bin Murshid had lost his life in a sortie during the siege of Sohar, Saif had died at about the same time at Rustak, and the only member of the old dynasty who could reasonably claim the Imamate was Bal 'Arrab who was then living in retirement in the interior and had no supporters on the coast. Ahmad bin S'aid of Sohar made the most of the favourable state of affairs and had no difficulty in getting recognized as Imam of Oman without any opposition. This happened in 1739.

Of the Persian troops who had come to the aid of Saif against Sultan bin Murshid only the garrisons of the two forts of Maskat remained in the country and they—numbering about two thousand men—soon after surrendered to Ahmad bin S'aid when the latter had killed their commander and his escort of 150 men who had unwisely accepted his invitation and gone to visit him at Barka. Persian interference in Oman now ceased for a time. Bal 'Arrab made some efforts to regain supremacy but lost his life in an engagement fought in 1741. With his death the Y'arrabi dynasty came to an end and Ahmad bin S'aid, the first of the S'aidi dynasty—which is still reigning—became undisputed ruler of Oman.

One of Ahmad bin S'aid's first acts after his accession was the establishment of a standing army in order to consolidate his power. His first army was

* NOTE.—Mirza Muhammad Taki Khan was the grandson of a baker (and the son of a mirab (an official charged with the distribution of water) of Shiraz. He rose to the position of a mustawfi (accountant in the Revenue Department), and when Nadir Shah assumed the sovereignty of Persia in 1736, he was appointed Governor of Fars and received the title of Khan. In the latter part of 1746 he declared himself independent and revolted. In the early part of the following year he was captured by Nadir Shah and punished by being emasculated and blinded. His sons and many of his supporters were killed at the same time.

NOTE.—The relation of events before Ahmad bin S'aid's accession is in accordance with the Arabic history of the Imams of Maskat and confirmed by contemporary Persian histories. Niebuhr, instead of 1736, when S'aid bin Sultan called in Persian aid, has 1746, and he places Ahmad's accession in 1749 instead of 1739, or 1741.

composed of one thousand free Arabs and eleven hundred slaves, a powerful force for Oman in those days, and his prestige among the Arab chiefs on the shores of the Persian Gulf became supreme. In 1756 when Basrah was besieged by Persian troops he sailed with ten thousand men in ten war ships and a number of smaller vessels to the relief of that place and utterly routed the Persians who fled towards Baghdad. For this very opportune aid the Sultan of Turkey rewarded him with a considerable pension which was paid year by year to him and his successors for over fifty years. Sultan Ahmad bin S'aid died in January 1775 and was succeeded by his son S'aid, who resigned in favour of his son Hamad in 1779. This, the third ruler of the Saidi dynasty, died March 13th, 1792, after an uneventful reign and was succeeded by his uncle Sultan bin Ahmad bin S'aid. Two or three years after his accession, Sultan bin Ahmad took possession of the Makran coast and the islands of Kishm and Hormuz from the Bani M'ain Arabs, and the Bahrain islands from the Uttubis, who had taken possession of them a few years before.*

It was during Sultan bin Ahmad's reign that the British authorities alarmed by the war with France and that nation's designs on India,† recognized the importance of Oman to their Indian commerce and concluded two treaties with its ruler. The first treaty between Oman and the East India Company was signed August 12th, 1798, and had for object an alliance with Oman against the designs of France and Dutch commercial rivalry and sanctioned the establishment of a factory with a garrison at Bandar Abassi and Pasidu (the Bassadore of maps and charts on Kishm island. As this was done without consulting the Court of Persia, the Shah was greatly displeased. The second treaty between Oman and the East India Company was concluded and signed January 18th, 1800, by Captain John Malcolm (afterwards General Sir John) as the British representative, and provided that an English gentleman‡ of respectability should always reside at Maskat and be the agent through whom all intercourse between Oman and Great Britain was to be done.

In 1803 the French frigate "Atalanta" arrived at Maskat and her Captain made overtures to Sultan bin Ahmad for effecting an alliance between Oman and France, but on the advice of the British Resident they were rejected. Sultan bin Ahmad then undertook a pilgrimage to Mekka returning to Maskat by way of Basrah in 1804. Soon after his return he sailed with a number of ships on an expedition against the Juvasmi pirates and lost his life, November 20th of the same year, in an engagement with them in the Clarence Straits (between Kishm and the mainland), near Bandar Lingah. Salim, his eldest son, who was then 16 years of age and had recently been expelled by the Uttubis from Bahrain, where he was acting as Deputy Governor for his father, succeeded to the Imamate, and revolts and disorders, which usually occur after the death of a ruler of Oman, naturally followed. During these disorders the Bani M'ain Arabs re-occupied the island of Kishm from which they had been expelled in 1795 by Sultan bin Ahmad, and also took Bandar Abassi, and the Wahabis came in and possessed themselves of Maskat. The British authorities now began to see the danger of non-interference and instructed Captain Seton, the Resident in the Persian Gulf, to assist Salim. Captain Seton thereupon affording assistance, Badr bin S'aif, a cousin of Salim, drove the Bani M'ain out of Kishm and Bandar Abassi. At the same time (1806) the Juvasmis were induced to conclude an agreement by which they engaged not to plunder British vessels, but they continued their piratical acts for many years after. The Wahabis had also been approached and on Salim's agreeing to pay them an annual tribute of 40,000 dollars they evacuated Maskat. In the following year (1807) Badr bin S'aif revolted, but Salim's younger brother S'aid came to the rescue and slew Badr at Barka in March. After this the people of Oman wished

*NOTE.—The Bahrain islands were occupied by Persian troops in 1736 and figured in Government accounts as a district of the province of Fars. Shaik Jabbarah of the Hula family who then was the ruler of Bahrain fled to Mekka. The Persians were expelled by the Uttubis.

†NOTE.—According to the Italian traveller Sestini, two French privateers were cruising in the Persian Gulf in August and September 1781, and the monthly mail-boat from Basrah to Bombay was much delayed in consequence.

‡NOTE.—It frequently happened that the British agent at Maskat was not an English gentleman, and sometimes there was no agent there at all. Morier, in 1808, states "We have a Resident at the Imam's Court, who seldom remains there long, for the badness of its air has rendered it the burial-place of too many Englishmen." Lieutenant-Colonel Johnson, who visited Maskat in 1817, writes that the East India Company had only a native agent at Maskat, because the Imam being a sincere friend of the English, there was no necessity of keeping a Resident. J. H. Stocqueler in 1831 speaks of the agent of the Bombay Government as being Reuben Aslam, a Jew, and Binning says that when he visited Maskat the British agent was a Jew merchant, an indolent non-chalant rascal. This was in 1851.

to proclaim S'aid, but the latter, with a rare respect for an elder brother, declined and the two brothers reigned together; S'aid, however, taking the lead, until Salim's death in 1821. At this time some coolness seems to have existed between the rulers of Oman and the British authorities in the Persian Gulf and S'aid imagining that the British were not in favour of his succeeding to the Imamate, sent an envoy to Mauritius with the object of obtaining the aid of France. General de Caen, the French representative in Mauritius did not object and without any delay concluded a treaty of alliance with Oman in June 15th, 1807, which was confirmed in July of the following year by another treaty and the arrival of Monsieur Dallons at Maskat as French Consul.

Notwithstanding the agreement of 1806, by which they had engaged not to plunder British vessels, the Juvasmis gave again much trouble in 1808.* Attacking her with 55 vessels they captured the large British merchant ship "Minerva" and murdered all her crew and passengers with the exception of Mrs. Taylor, the wife of Captain Taylor, of the Indian Navy and Assistant Resident in the Persian Gulf, and two European gentlemen; also captured the British cruiser "Sylph"† murdering 22 of her crew; attacked the cruiser "Nautilus;" destroyed a number of Omani ships and threatened Bushire with a fleet of 70 sail. The valiant S'aid marched against the Juvasmis and attacked their Chief, Shaikh Sultan of Rasal Khaima, but was defeated and lost his brother Kais in the engagement. The Chief of the Juvasmis not only considered himself of greater importance than the Imam of Maskat but demanded a tribute from the British Government and continued to make the Gulf unsafe. In 1809 S'aid undertook another expedition against the Juvasmi pirates and was assisted by a small force of Arabs from Bushire, but his allies failed to co-operate and his fleet which was sailing to attack Rasal Khaima was dispersed with great loss. The British authorities now again intervened and two of their frigates captured some pirates and demolished the fort of Laft on Kishm island. The prisoners were taken to Bombay but released very soon after. In September of the same year Colonel (afterwards General, Sir) Lionel Smith left Bombay with the 65th English Regiment on some war ships commanded by Commodore Rowley and Captain Wainwright, destroyed Rasal Khaima and the Juvasmi fleet, recovered the British merchantman "Minerva" which the pirates had captured in 1808, bombarded and took Julfar (November 13th), captured Shinas (January 1810) and, having broken the power of the Juvasmis, returned to Bombay. The power of the Juvasmis was, however, not completely broken, for soon after their reverses in 1809, 26 of their ships were cruising in the Gulf near Bandar Lingah, Kais, etc., and on February 27th, 1811, the "Lion" of 64 guns had an engagement with them off the Island Shaikh Shu'aib (Bushaib). While S'aid, the Imam of Oman, was occupied with the Juvasmis, he had allowed the payment of his tribute to the Wahabis to fall in arrear, and the Wahabi chief Shaikh, Saud II, came to enforce it and arrived at Ras al Khaima and Shinas shortly after the British expedition under Colonel Smith had left those ports. S'aid marched out to oppose Saud and was forced to retreat to Maskat leaving the Wahabis to raid the country without opposition. In 1811 S'aid suffered another defeat from the Wahabis close to the walls of Maskat and appealed to the British Government for help, but the Bombay Government then considered it impolitic to offend the Wahabis and refused to interfere. The rulers of Oman being aware that French help was out of the question, Bourbon and Mauritius having capitulated to the British the year before and the Indian Ocean having practically become a *mare clausum* to the French, bethought themselves of Persia, and Salim proceeded to Shiraz in order to obtain assistance from the Shah. A force of two or three thousand men was provided and Salim reached Maskat with it in the beginning of 1812. S'aid then again gave battle to the Wahabis and was again defeated and most of his Persian allies were killed. Another expedition which S'aid undertook against the Juvasmis of Rasal Khaima in the following year was also unsuccessful and S'aid was repulsed with great loss.

At this period it was fortunate for Oman that the Egyptian troops sent against the Wahabis by Muhammad Ali Pasha were victorious, that Matlak, one of the Wahabi Commanders was killed (November 1813), and that Shaikh Saud, the Chief of the Wahabis, died soon after. The Wahabis in consequence

* NOTE.—According to Morier the Juvasmis then had 63 large and 810 small vessels with 19,000 men.

† NOTE.—The "Sylph" was soon after recovered by the "Nereide" which also sunk a large Javaami ship with a crew of 300.

retired from Oman and S'aid could employ his whole forces against the Juvasmis who were attacking the Makran coast with a large fleet composed of vessels with two or three guns and 300 men each. An attempt which S'aid made to intercept the pirates off the Persian coast failed, he being repulsed and severely wounded. He also barely escaped capture together with his frigate, the "Caroline," of forty guns. At about the same time a small British squadron sailed on an expedition against Ras al Khaima and returned without having achieved any result. Again, in 1816, S'aid attacked the Juvasmis of Rasal Khaima and again he was repulsed; a little later in the same year he undertook an expedition against Bahrain with the assistance of three Persian ships. His ill-fortune pursued him. His forces were routed when landing and his brother Hamad was among the killed. The Shah of Persia now offered further help and S'aid, by no means discouraged by his many reverses, prepared for another expedition against the Juvasmis soon after his return from Bahrain and sailed for Bandar Kongun in order to embark the Persian troops who were waiting there for him. However, just before he reached Kongun, he received private information that the Persian troops had the Shah's orders to seize him and take him to Shiraz, and he returned to Maskat.

Ibrahim Pasha, son of Muhammad Ali Pasha of Egypt, then promised to come to his aid, but was not able to keep his promise being fully occupied with the Wahabis, who had retrieved their losses of 1813 and were again in open revolt. S'aid now again turned to France and concluded with that power the treaty of March 10th, 1818—which remained in force until the commercial treaty of 1844 was signed—but nothing was done against the Juvasmis until the following year, and then it was again Great Britain that came to the rescue. In November 1819, General Sir William Keir arrived at Maskat with a strong detachment composed of His Majesty's 47th and 65th Regiments of Infantry, a Company of Artillery and 2,500 sepoys, and was joined by Said with 4,000 men of Oman. Shortly after the allied forces took Ras al Khaima and Julfar and completely broke the power of the Juvasmis, who were glad to come to terms and signed a treaty with Captain Thompson, the British Resident, on January 8th, 1820. General Keir, having brought his expedition to a successful issue, returned to Bombay, leaving about 800 men at Basidu on Kishm island with the object of assisting Said against the Bani Bu Ali Arabs of Ras al Hadd, who had committed acts of piracy and killed the pilot of a British cruiser. The Shah of Persia considered these proceedings by the East India Company in the Persian Gulf, particularly the establishment of a garrison on the island of Kishm, without his assent, an infringement of his sovereign rights and made representations to this effect to the British Government (London) without much success, the sovereignty of Persia over the islands in the Persian Gulf being by no means recognised.

Soon after General Keir's departure Captain Thompson, the Resident, sailed with six companies of the sepoys, which the General had left at Basidu, for Ras al Hadd, in order to punish the Bani Bu Ali Arabs for the murder of the pilot and, having landed at Sur, near Ras al Hadd, was joined by a force of 2,000 men under S'aid. The Bani Bu Ali at first retreated and were followed by the allied troops until they reached a place in the neighbourhood of their principal stronghold, and there, when the allies were marching through a grove of date palms, the whole tribe fell upon them. Six British officers and 400 sepoys were killed and the whole force would have been annihilated, but for the personal gallantry of S'aid, who, though severely wounded at the first onslaught showed a bold front and effected an orderly retreat of the remaining forces to the coast. The Bani Bu Ali gave no quarter to the wounded and even dragged out of his palanquin the British Surgeon who was very ill and butchered him on the spot. Of the British force only Captain Thompson, two officers, and 150 men escaped and found shelter behind the walls of Maskat. There is but too much reason to believe that this unfortunate expedition ought never to have been undertaken, and that it was a concession on the part of Captain Thompson to the interests of the rulers of Oman and not warranted by instructions from the Bombay Government; but for Captain Thompson's justification it may be said that the murder of the pilot was an outrage which necessitated the chastisement of the Arabs for the sake of British prestige in the Gulf. When the news of the

disaster reached Bombay, the Indian Government at once took steps to retrieve the tarnished lustre of the British arms. In January 1821, General Sir Lionel Smith, the same officer who led the expedition against the Juvasmis in 1809, sailed from Bombay with 3,000 men and reached Sûr in the following month. The Bani Bu Ali mustered only some 800 warriors, but nowise daunted met the British force in a plain and a pitched battle ensued, March 2nd, 1821. The Arabs fought until almost annihilated and nearly the whole tribe was left dead on the field. Their fort was then destroyed and the chief and some of the other male survivors who had been taken prisoner were sent to Bombay where they resided for two years, supplied with all comforts and luxuries, until sent back to their native country with valuable presents. They were also supplied with the means to rebuild their fort.

In 1822, Captain Moresby, of His Majesty's ship "Minai," concluded a treaty for the suppression of the slave trade with Said, who was now sole ruler of Oman, his brother Salim having died the year before, and in 1824 Said made the pilgrimage to Mekka sailing to the Red Sea and back on board his famous 74 gun ship "Liverpool" which he had purchased from the British Government in 1822 and presented to King William IV twelve years later (1836).

In 1826, Fath Ali Shah of Persia, wishing to make amends for his unfriendly action towards Oman in 1816, when he wanted to seize Salim, assented to one of his nieces being given in marriage to Said. The young Princess travelled in great state from Teheran to Bushire where she was to embark for Maskat, but Shaikh Abdur Rasul of the Matarish tribe, Chief of Bushire, seized and detained her with the view of marrying her himself. Thereupon Said came up with his fleet, blockaded Bushire, and captured Abdur Rasul whom he kept prisoner at Maskat for about a year, only liberating him on receiving a ransom amounting to 80,000 dollars. The princess entered Said's harem as his second Persian wife. Also in this year a quarrel arose between Oman and Turkey, and Said blockaded Basra, captured the Pasha of that place and retired on receipt of 104,000 dollars. At this period Said's rule was fully recognized all along the Persian coast from the neighbourhood of Bushire to Baluchistan and the customs of Bandar Abassi gave him an income of 10,000 tumans per annum.

In 1828, Said made another attempt on Bahrain, but was again repulsed by the Uttubis who held the islands. In the following year Said sailed in the "Liverpool," accompanied by a large fleet, to Zanzibar to quell a revolt started by Salim, the Sultan of Mumbassa, and in May 1830 he returned to Maskat where disorders had broken out during his absence. In February of the following year Shaikh Hamud of Sohar gave trouble and Said who had marched against him without, it seems, having made proper preparations, was defeated with a loss of 400 men.

In 1832, Sultan Salim of Mumbassa revolted again and Said hastened to Zanzibar, leaving his son Thuvaini at Maskat as his deputy. Said bombarded Mumbassa and obliged Salim to sign a treaty recognizing him as sovereign and agreeing to pay him half the customs' receipts of Mumbassa and allow a permanent garrison of fifty men from Oman at that port. Instead of the fifty men stipulated Said sent two hundred, expelled Sultan Salim from Mumbassa, and captured a number of the leading men of the place whom he sent to Hormuz island where they were starved to death in the cisterns of the old Portuguese fort. In October 1832, Said had to return to Maskat for quelling some disorders caused by the Wahabis and in order to have peace agreed to pay them an annual tribute of 5,000 dollars. The terms of this agreement were communicated to the British Resident in the Persian Gulf by a letter dated May 23rd, 1833.

In September of this year, the United States of America's sloop of war "Peacock" arrived at Maskat and a commercial treaty between Oman and the United States was concluded and signed by Said and Mr. Roberts, the American representative. Renewed troubles at Mumbassa obliged Said shortly after to proceed to Zanzibar and restore order by the usual bombardment of the port. This done he heard that Maskat had taken its turn to revolt, so he quickly went to Maskat and arranged matters. Said then had a little rest, but in 1836, Sultan Salim of Mumbassa having died and several notables claiming the Sultanate of Zanzibar, he sailed for Mumbassa. After the customary

bombardment he captured Rashid, a son of the late Salim, and several other pretenders to the Sultanate and sent them away, ostensibly to Bandar Abassi; but they were killed by his orders on the way.

It was in this year that Said presented his 74 gun man-of-war "Liverpool" to King William IV, the king giving him in return the Royal Yacht the "Prince Regent." Again Said had some peace and rest and remained in Zanzibar until September 1839. The Wahabis gave some trouble in Oman in 1838, but being again defeated by the Egyptian troops retired to inner Arabia and were quiet until 1843. In the beginning of 1838, after the news of Queen Victoria's accession had reached Zanzibar, Said sent an embassy to London to congratulate Her Majesty. In May 1839, Said concluded a commercial treaty with Great Britain, and in September of that year went to Maskat leaving his son Khalad as his deputy in Zanzibar. After a short stay at Maskat he returned to Zanzibar and resided there until 1843, when he proceeded to Maskat with the view of preparing an expedition against Bahrain. The British authorities persuaded him to desist from his intended attack on Bahrain, and, again leaving his son Thuvaini in charge of Oman, he once more took up his residence in Zanzibar. Said seems to have placed full confidence in his son Thuvaini and evidently did not think it necessary to proceed to Oman even when Amir Faizal of Katif, a Wahabi chief, worried the people of Oman, and also raised no objection to the treaty which Thuvaini concluded with the Wahabis in 1845.

French intrigues on the east coast of Africa, which began in 1840 and led to a concession of great privileges to France in November 1841, resulted in a treaty, signed November 17th, 1844, between Said, for Oman and Zanzibar, and France, represented by Captain Komain Desses, commanding the French man-of-war "Crocodile," and a French Consul's appearance at Zanzibar on the same day the treaty was signed.

In September 1845, Hilal, the eldest son of Said, went to London with the object of seeking redress against his father who, as he alleged, persistently ill-treated him, kept him altogether out of Government affairs and unjustly, to his detriment, favoured his younger brothers. Said was asked for explanations and having justified his conduct, the British authorities interred Hilal at Aden, where he died October 28th, 1851. Thuvaini in 1845 had concluded a new treaty, as already mentioned, with the Wahabis and agreed to pay them a tribute of 7,000 dollars per annum instead of the 5,000 which his father had agreed to in 1832.

For nine years after this (1845) nothing happened to disturb the peace in Said's dominions and, with the exception of a five months' visit to Maskat in 1851, he resided in Zanzibar.

In 1854 difficulties arose with the Wahabis and the Persians, and Said after proclaiming his son Khalad his successor, left Zanzibar for Maskat, arriving there April 18th.

The difficulty with the Wahabis was caused by Thuvaini's remissness in paying the tribute stipulated by the terms of the treaty of 1845, but thanks to the intervention of the British Resident in the Persian Gulf (Captain, later General Sir Arnold Kemball) bloodshed was avoided and a new treaty concluded by which Said agreed to pay all arrears and an annual tribute of 12,000 dollars for Maskat and dependencies and 8,000 dollars for Sohar, where Turki, the fifth son of Said, was governor.

The trouble with Persia was more serious. As has been related before, the Bani M'ain Arabs held the Persian Gulf islands of Kishm, Hormuz, etc., and the ports of the Kirman and Makran coasts, excepting Bandar Abassi, until 1795, when they were expelled by the Omanis. Bandar Abassi and its dependencies had then been a Persian possession for nearly two centuries and Persian supremacy over the other ports whence the Bani M'ain had been expelled, was also recognized and Oman agreed to pay for them an annual rental of six thousand Tumans to Persia. This rental had been regularly paid. Persia's supremacy over the islands was, however, open to doubt and was not recognized, as the action of the British authorities in treating only with Oman and ignoring Persia in the matter of the settlement at Basidu on Kishm island proved. In 1854, the Shah of Persia laid claim to the islands and insisted upon an increased rental for the ports, and Oman not entertaining his demands, sent a considerable force to Bandar Abassi. The Persians expelled

Saif bin Nabhan, the Omani governor of Bandar Abassi, as well as all Omani garrisons and agents, from that place and other ports and committed many outrages on the inhabitants. Said's son Thuvaini who was then sent in command of an expedition to Bandar Abassi re-occupied that port and its dependencies without much trouble, but strong Persian reinforcements having arrived from Shiraz, he was forced to retreat with considerable losses, many of his men being taken prisoner and sent to Shiraz. Said himself then for some time blockaded Bandar Abassi, but finally abandoning all hope of recovering the place by force of arms made terms with the Persians and concluded a treaty with them in April 1856. By the terms of this treaty Bandar Abassi and dependencies (Shamil, Minan, Issin, Tasiyan, Biaban) and the islands of Kishm, Hormuz, etc., were declared to be Persian territory and leased to the Sultan of Oman for a period of twenty years at an annual rental of 16,000 Tumans; the fortifications of Bandar Abassi were to be demolished and after the expiration of the twenty years the agents of the Sultan of Oman were to quit Bandar Abassi and the other places and be replaced by agents appointed by Persia. After this humiliation Said returned to Maskat and remained there until September 15th, 1856, when he set sail for Zanzibar on board his ship "Victoria," his son Barghash accompanying him on the "Artemisia," another of his ships, and Thuvaini, as on previous occasions, remaining as his deputy at Maskat. This was the last of Said's many voyages. During the few days before his departure from Maskat he had a strange foreboding of death, and after bidding a final farewell to his mother Ghani, a lady more than eighty years of age, and taking planks for his coffin with him, left the country which he had ruled for half a century. His presentiments had not deceived him and not long after his departure from Maskat and when in the neighbourhood of the Seychelles he died, and six days later was buried at Zanzibar.

Said was born in 1790 and died sixty-six years and seven months of age, September 19th, 1856. He had no issue by his three legal wives (two Persian, one Arab), but 24 sons and 12 daughters by concubines; fifteen sons survived him.

During his long and eventful reign of over fifty years Said was a staunch friend and ally of Great Britain and his appealing once or twice to France was, it is believed, not with any hostile intentions towards Great Britain but only with the object of obtaining aid against the Wahabis and Juvasmis, when the British authorities were not able to help him, and means to keep his fleet in a state of efficiency. It is, however, quite certain that Said's appeals to France helped him very little if at all and their only result seems to have been to make the British authorities at times suspect his good faith and cause some coolness in the relations between him and them. It was by means of his fleet that he was able to maintain his supremacy among the Arabs of the Gulf and that, as we have seen, with great difficulties. His 74-gun ship the "Liverpool" was the largest vessel that had ever appeared in Arabian and Persian waters and during the latter part of his reign his navy comprised nine frigates and corvettes (one, the "Shah Alam" of 54 guns), six sloops and brigs and many smaller vessels.* Maskat during Said's reign grew from a small and insignificant place to a town with a population of fifty to sixty thousand and acquired considerable commercial importance.

After Said's death Thuvaini reigned at Maskat and Khalad, whom Said had appointed his successor in Zanzibar in April 1854, was ruler of Zanzibar until his death, November 7th, 1856, a fortnight after his father's burial. Majid, Said's fourth son, then assumed sovereignty and Thuvaini in due time objected. Finally, after much contention, claims, counter-claims and fighting for the succession to the sovereignty of the two dominions, a treaty was concluded between the two brothers to the effect that Zanzibar and its dependencies were to belong to Majid and his successors and Oman and dependencies to Thuvaini and successors on the condition of the latter's receiving annually from the former 40,000 dollars. As the revenues of the Zanzibar dominion then amounted to 206,000 dollars and those of Maskat and Oman to 129,500 Zanzibar's payment to the ruler of Oman (40,000) made the revenues of each about the same, *viz.*, 169,500 for Oman and 166,000 for Zanzibar. This division

*NOTE.—Stack mentions that Maskat in 1864 possessed a 36-gun frigate and several corvettes. The frigate was soon after sold to a Parsi firm and the corvettes were disposed of later, and in 1881, at the time of Stack's visit, the Sultan of Maskat had no ships. Stack also states that many guns were cast for Said in 1850 by Cyrus Meyer & Co., of Boston, America.

of the Oman and Zanzibar dominions and their revenues was confirmed by Lord Canning's arbitration of 1862 and on March 10th of that year, Great Britain and France signed a convention by which they agreed to respect the independence of Maskat.

In 1865, when the Wahabis again disturbed the peace of the Gulf, the British authorities intervened and the Wahabis, not listening to reason, gave them an ultimatum on January 6th, 1866. This also having no effect. Captain Pasley of H. M.'s ship "Highflyer" destroyed their port of Katif on February 2nd. On the next day Captain Pasley attacked Daman and was repulsed with a loss of three killed, but on the 11th he was more successful at Sur destroying that port with all its shipping.

On that day (February 11th, 1866) Sultan Thuvaini was assassinated by his son Salim and serious disorders ensued at Maskat. The British Resident in the Gulf (Colonel, afterwards Major General Sir, Lewis Pelly) who was then on board H. M.'s ship "Berenice" at Cape Masandam, thereupon proceeded to Sohar, liberated Turki bin Said, a younger brother of Thuvaini, who had been kept there as a prisoner, and then went to Maskat. On his arrival there the British subjects took refuge on board the "Berenice" but the disorders were quickly quelled and Salim was formally recognized Sultan of Maskat by the British authorities. Turki, however, soon after revolted against his nephew Salim and the British authorities sent the frigate "Octavia" and the steamer "May Frere" to Salim's assistance and also placed 40,000 dollars at his disposal as an advance on the annual payment by Zanzibar. Turki then offered to make terms agreeing to give up his claims, leave Maskat and reside in British territory on the condition of receiving a yearly pension of 7,200 dollars. Salim having accepted these terms Turki sailed for Bombay, arriving there in September 1867.

In 1868, Hamad bin Salim, a cousin of the late Thuvaini, gave some trouble at Barka, and Salim, the Sultan, being without the necessary funds for purchasing supplies for his troops applied to the British authorities for aid. Colonel Pelly advanced 10,000 dollars and Salim, after provisioning his troops, marched against Barka, November 7th. Through the good offices of his *vizir*, Hajji Ahmad Khan, he was able to enlist in his favour the Hinavi Arabs of J'alan. Hamad thereupon surrendered and the revolt was quelled without any fighting or bloodshed.

In the following year Azzan bin Kais bin Ahmad bin Said revolted and occupied Maskat, October 3rd, expelling Sultan Salim who took refuge with Colonel Pelly, the British Resident on board the "Vigilant." The latter negotiated with Azzan and recommended a truce pending the arrival of instructions from his Government, but Azzan saying that he had come to fight and not to talk, fired upon the forts and endangered the British shipping in the harbour. Some time before this the British Government had presented Salim with two long 18-pounders and Colonel Pelly now asked Azzan not to use them in his bombardment of the forts, but Azzan carried one of them off during the night of the 5th and used it against the fort into which Captain Brown of the "Vigilant" had placed a rocket party. On October 7th, a telegram from the Government reached Colonel Pelly instructing him to render no assistance to Salim, but to favour Turki. But Turki was then in Bombay, and the British Resident after informing Salim that he could not assist him, publicly recognized Azzan as Sultan of Maskat and fired a salute in honour of his accession. Salim, accompanied by his factotum Hajji Ahmad Khan, sailed for Bandar Abassi on the 11th of the month on board the frigate "Prince of Wales" and the attempts which he afterwards made to recover his sovereignty were rendered futile by the British authorities. Azzan in the meantime consolidated his power and defeated the Wahabis and the Bani Bu Ali Arabs who, during and after the recent disorders at Maskat, had raided some of its districts. In March 1870 the British Government permitted Turki to leave Bombay and fresh disorders ensued in consequence; finally, after continuous fighting between Azzan and Turki the British authorities in 1871 recognized Turki* as Sultan of Maskat, Azzan was deposed and order was restored.

* NOTE.—Turki died June 4th, 1888, and was succeeded by his son Faizal.

In 1870 an arrangement was come to between the Indian and Home Governments for permanently keeping three gunboats in the Persian Gulf, the Indian Government paying £70,000 per annum towards the expenditure and also keeping in a state of efficiency as a reserve three other ships at Bombay and Trincomalee.

PROCEEDINGS OF THE
FOREIGN DEPARTMENT, MARCH 1905.

History of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf.

Pro. No. 858

No. 1021-E.B., dated Fort William the 10th March 1905.

Pro. No. 858.

From—The Assistant Secretary to the Government of India in the Foreign Department,

To—LIEUTENANT J. A. DOUGLAS, Military Attaché, British Legation, Tehran.

I am directed to acknowledge the receipt of your letter No. 1,* dated the 3rd January 1905, forwarding notes compiled by General Houtum Schindler, C.I.E., on "The History of Oman and events in the Persian Gulf from the fall of the Yarrabi dynasty to the accession of Sultan Sayyid Turki in 1871." * Pro. No. 857.

2. I am to request that General Schindler may be thanked for his interesting notes, a copy of which has been forwarded to Mr. J. G. Lorimer, C.I.E., Officer in charge of the Compilation of the Persian Gulf Gazetteer.

I am to add that the Government of India desire to avoid giving any unnecessary publicity to the fact that they are undertaking the preparation of this manual which is intended only for the confidential use of Government officials.

No. 1022-E.B., dated Fort William, the 10th March 1905.

Pro. No. 859.

Endorsed by Foreign Department.

† Pro. No. 857. Letter† from the Military Attaché, British Legation, Tehran, No. 1, dated the 3rd January 1905.

A copy of the foregoing letter, with enclosures, is forwarded to Mr. J. G. Lorimer, C.I.E., Officer on special duty, Persian Gulf, for information.